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More to Give

Your giving doesn't just have to be focused on your family, of course. There are opportunities all around to put your wealth to good use in the world. Our research found that net-worth millionaires are much more generous than the general population, as 55% of millionaires give to others regularly, compared to 28% of the general population. Some give monthly and some give as needs arise, but most—70%—say they set some of their income aside every month to give to others. Only one in ten millionaires says giving is *not* part of their personal finances. The bottom line is that millionaires are givers.

If giving in large amounts freaks you out or you don't want anyone to know you have that much money to give away, then give it anonymously. You don't need credit; the focus should be on the gift, not the giver. And if you've never practiced regular, generous giving, you have no idea what you're missing out on. No matter who you are or how much you have, giving *always* feels good. It's a fact. I've never known a millionaire to lie on his deathbed and say, "I wish I hadn't given so much to other people." Instead, they're more likely to look back on a life of giving and wish they could have done even more.

That kind of radical giving has become a huge part of many, many millionaires' lives. A great example of this is Thomas, a millionaire I told you about earlier in the book.